

ANGEL ACTION · ENVIRONMENTAL

Hypothermia

Hypothermia is a drop in core body temperature below 35°C. Move the person to shelter, remove wet clothing, rewarm gradually with blankets and body heat, and call 000 if severe.

Signs

- Shivering (may stop in severe cases)
- Cold, pale skin
- Numbness
- Slurred speech, confusion, drowsiness
- Slow weak pulse and breathing

What to do

1. **Call 000** if severe.
2. Move to a warm, dry, sheltered place.
3. Handle gently — rough movement can trigger cardiac arrest.
4. Remove wet clothing; replace with dry layers or blankets.
5. Cover the head and neck.
6. Rewarm **gradually** with blankets, body warmth and a warm (not hot) environment.
7. Give **warm sweet drinks** only if fully conscious. **No alcohol or caffeine.**
8. Do not rub the skin or apply direct heat (hot water bottles, heaters).
9. Be ready to start **CPR** — continue for longer than normal in hypothermia.

*Adapted from **Australian First Aid 5th Edition**. Get the full guide and live CPR metronome at firstaidangel.org.*